TRACK DETAILS

Company Name : Cactus Communications (Paperpal)

# of tracks you are sponsoring : 1

Prize Money amount details you will be sponsoring for each track: INR 25K

- **Winner :** INR 15K
- **First runner up :** INR 10K
- **Second runner up (optional) :** If there is a tie or two runner ups then both runner ups will get 5K each i.e splitting the 10K amount.
- **Consolation prize (optional) : - Opportunity for AI and Engineering Internship with us**

Track Name : Fix My Format, Agent Paperpal

Website(s) –
https://paperpal.com/
https://paperpal.com/manuscript-check
https://paperpal.com/preflight
https://www.editage.com/

Logo(s) –

Problem Statement –

Manuscript formatting

Description –

Academic publishing demands strict adherence to journal-specific formatting styles such as APA, MLA, Chicago, AMA, Vancouver, and others. Each journal often has its own nuanced guidelines covering citation structure, heading hierarchies, abstract formats, reference styling, figure labeling, statistical reporting, and even language conventions. Despite the availability of templates and reference managers, researchers and students spend countless hours manually reformatting manuscripts to meet submission requirements. Formatting errors are among the most common reasons for manuscript rejection or delays in peer review.
With the rise of intelligent systems, there is an opportunity to move beyond static templates and build **agentic AI systems** that can autonomously interpret journal guidelines and dynamically transform manuscripts to meet required standards.

The Challenge -

Design and develop an **agentic manuscript formatting system** that can automatically align a research manuscript with the formatting and stylistic requirements of a specified academic journal or style guide (e.g., APA 7th edition).

Your solution should:

- Analyze a given manuscript (Word, PDF, or plain text).
- Identify structural elements such as title page, abstract, headings, citations, references, tables, and figures.
- Interpret the selected journal's formatting rules.
- Automatically transform the document to comply with those requirements.
- Ensure consistency between in-text citations and references and maintain pre-existing linkages if any.
- Preserve the semantic integrity and original content of the manuscript.

Expected Innovation

Participants are encouraged to build systems that go beyond simple formatting scripts.

Consider incorporating:

- Rule-based + Agentic AI-driven formatting engines
- Natural language processing for structural detection
- Citation parsing and validation mechanisms
- Compliance scoring dashboards
- Modular design to support multiple style guides

Bonus points for solutions that:

- Provide real-time formatting suggestions
- Offer explainable corrections
- Support multiple journal templates
- Integrate with common writing tools (e.g., Google Docs, MS Word)

Impact

A successful solution could significantly reduce the time researchers spend on formatting, minimize desk rejections, and streamline the academic publishing process. By automating

compliance with journal guidelines, this system empowers researchers to focus more on innovation and scholarship rather than technical formatting constraints.

Input – Style and formatting guidelines document, MS Word file/any document as raw manuscript.

Output(s)

- Apply style and transform the doc/docx file based on guidelines
- Example style for first testing and solving (APA style) - https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/research_and_citation/apa_style/apa_formatting_and_style_guide/general_f…

Deliverable – API demo with input and output files or a simple web doc editor/viewer like UI where you can input the dox to show current format and show the style guide chosen and transformed to the new format.

References –

Note - During the hackathon, try to evaluate and build things fast, make sure you are understanding the nuances of how to deal with research document formats better. Even if final product is not great, intermediate steps identification and partial automation is also evaluated with equal weightage to running end product.

Sidenote: Brownie points and potential to get shortlisted for internship by registering and using Paperpal and Rdiscovery (with gen AI based Ask RDiscovery) *on web and chrome store, looking at the existing features and giving suggestion/feedback on overall product and discussing about how the hackathon projects can fit into the product(s) while presenting/talking with mentors :D*

Mentor Details :

1) **Riddhi Shah, Product Manager, Paperpal, Cactus Communications**
- **Linkedin - https://www.linkedin.com/in/i-riddhishah/**

2) **Sachinkumar Patel, Software Architect, Paperpal, Cactus Communications**
- **Linkedin -** https://www.linkedin.com/in/sachin-patel-7307b21a

3) **Kunal Sawhney, Senior Manager, Engineering, Cactus Communications**
- **Linkedin -** https://www.linkedin.com/in/kunal-sawhney-607aa3bb/

4) **Fenil Ramoliya, Machine Learning Engineer, Cactus Communications (MiNED 2024 winner 😀)**
- **Linkedin -** https://www.linkedin.com/in/fenilramoliya210/

5) **Bhargav Modha, Machine Learning Engineer, Cactus Communications (MINED 2023 winner 😀)**
- **Linkedin -** https://www.linkedin.com/in/bhargav-modha/

Evaluation Details :

- Evaluation will be done based on
    - How accurately style guide is followed and document is formatted (30%)
    - Working demo (30%)
    - Presentation and Engagement with Mentor(s) (20%)
    - Tech Scalability (20%)

Signature: Parth Agrawal, Cactus Communications